

# Cover Letter – Principal Architect / Visionary Technical Leader at Smartsheet

**Yongjun Rong**

Cherry Hill, NJ 08003

rongyj@hotmail.com

856-408-4027

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/rongyongjun/>

**Date:** [Current Date]

**Smartsheet**

[Company Address]

[City, State ZIP]

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Principal Architect / Visionary Technical Leader position at Smartsheet. With over 20 years of experience architecting and building cloud-native, enterprise-grade SaaS solutions, I am inspired by Smartsheet's mission to empower teams with smart, scalable tools and to drive innovation through AI and automation. I am eager to contribute my expertise in distributed systems, AI/ML integration, and technical leadership to help shape the future of your platform and deliver impactful solutions for your customers.

## Why I'm Excited About Smartsheet

Smartsheet's focus on enabling teams to automate, uncover insights, and scale smarter aligns perfectly with my background in building robust, scalable platforms and integrating advanced AI capabilities. Your commitment to innovation, collaboration, and empowering users resonates deeply with my own values and leadership style.

## Relevant Experience & Impact

**Cloud-Native & Distributed Systems Architecture** - Led the architecture and delivery of large-scale, highly available SaaS and cloud-native platforms at Biophy, McKinsey, Yotascale, and Barclays - Extensive hands-on experience with AWS (EC2, Lambda, S3, VPC, EKS/Kubernetes, CloudWatch), Kubernetes, Docker, and service-oriented architectures - Designed and implemented microservices, event-driven systems, and robust REST APIs for enterprise clients

**AI/ML Integration & Innovation** - Architected and delivered genAI, RAG, and multi-agent AI systems for real-time data pipeline generation, automation, and customer engagement - Integrated AI-powered features into enterprise SaaS products, leveraging vector databases, OpenAI APIs, and advanced analytics - Defined patterns and best practices for AI integration across complex, multi-system architectures

**Technical Leadership & Mentorship** - Built and mentored high-performing engineering teams, established technical standards, and led architecture review boards - Guided and coached engineers on best practices, project designs, and technical direction - Fostered strong partnerships with Product, UX, and business stakeholders to align technical vision with business needs

**Strategic Vision & Execution** - Translated business goals into scalable, robust technical solutions, driving digital transformation and modernization initiatives - Set technical roadmaps, defined engineering methodologies, and influenced organizational direction across multiple teams

## **Why I'm a Strong Fit for Smartsheet**

My experience leading cloud-native architecture, integrating AI/ML into SaaS products, and mentoring technical teams positions me to drive Smartsheet's technical vision and innovation. I thrive on solving complex distributed systems problems, building scalable solutions, and empowering teams to deliver business value. I am excited about the opportunity to help Smartsheet expand its AI portfolio and set new standards for technical excellence.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and vision align with Smartsheet's goals and how I can contribute to your continued success.

Sincerely,

**Yongjun Rong**